



## **WORKER COOPERATIVES**

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A worker cooperative is a business owned by its workers. There is no single owner, and the workers run the business by and for themselves. The business may be run by all the members democratically or by an elected management. A worker coop, some people argue, is the natural alternative to businesses run purely for profit. Instead of capital hiring workers, workers hire capital and this gives the workers more control.



## **HOUSING COOPERATIVES**

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A housing cooperative owns and runs residential property on behalf of those who live there. By pooling resources, members of a housing coop can buy better housing and services than they could afford individually. When anyone leaves, the coop's management selects new residents on behalf of members. For many people, housing coops are the only way to get decent housing.



## **CONSUMER COOPERATIVES**

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A consumer coop is a business owned by its customers. By clubbing together, members gain the clout to get big savings from bulk purchasing, or cutting out profit-hungry retailers. The goal is to provide members with goods at the lowest price possible rather than offering them at the highest price shoppers will pay in order to maximize profits. The UK's Cooperative Group is the world's largest consumer coop, comprising stores, insurance, travel, funeral, and banking services.